

Absolutely — **pastry** is a useful polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “the shop sells handmade bread, **pastries**, cakes...”

Here **pastries** means **small baked foods made from pastry dough, often sweet or filled**. But **pastry** also has a distinct mass-noun meaning for **the dough itself**, and a few useful compounds such as **puff pastry** and **shortcrust pastry**.

Word family: **pastry**

Base word: **pastry**

Plural: **pastries**

Part of speech: **noun (名詞)**

Meaning in your passage: **pastry** = individual baked pastry item — 酥點 ; 糕點

Your sentence:

> “The shop sells handmade bread, **pastries**, cakes...”

Here **pastries** means:

> **small baked foods made from pastry dough, often sweet, flaky, filled, or topped.**

繁體中文 :

以酥皮 / 糕點麵糰製作的小型烘焙食品，常帶甜味、餡料或層次酥皮；酥點 / 糕點

Natural translation:

> “The shop sells handmade bread, **pastries**, cakes...”

「這間店售賣手工麵包、**酥點 / 糕點**、蛋糕……」

So here:

> **pastries** = 一件件可數的酥點 / 糕點

1. **pastry** = dough used for pies/tarts etc. — 酥皮麵糰 ; 糕點麵糰

This is the core mass-noun sense.

Practice 1

> “Roll out the **pastry** thinly.”

「把**酥皮麵糰**擀薄。」

Practice 2

> “The pastry needs to rest before baking.”

「這份**酥皮麵糰**在烘焙前需要靜置。」

pastry = 用麵粉和脂肪等製成、用來做批、撻、酥點的麵糰

Usually uncountable here.

2. **pastry** = baked item made from pastry dough — 酥點；糕點

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The shop sells handmade **pastries**.”

「這間店售賣手工**酥點 / 糕點**。」

Practice 4

> “She bought two pastries for breakfast.”

「她早餐買了兩件**酥點**。」

pastry — countable = 由 pastry dough 製成的一件烘焙食品

Examples:

- * Danish
- * croissant
- * tart
- * turnover

depending on usage.

3. **pastry = category of baked goods — 糕點類；酥點類**

A broader culinary category use.

Practice 5

> “He trained in bread and **pastry**.”

「他接受過麵包和**糕點製作**訓練。」

Practice 6

> “The school offers a course in pastry.”

「這間學校提供**糕點製作**課程。」

pastry = 作為烘焙專業 / 類別來說的糕點製作領域

This is broader than one individual pastry.

4. **puff pastry = 千層酥皮；酥皮**

A very common compound.

Practice 7

> “The tart is made with **puff pastry**.”

「這個撻使用**千層酥皮**製作。」

Practice 8

> “Puff pastry becomes light and flaky when baked.”

「**千層酥皮**烘焙後會變得輕盈酥脆。」

puff pastry = 多層摺疊脂肪與麵糰製成、烘焙後形成層層酥脆結構的酥皮

5. **shortcrust pastry = 短酥皮；撻皮**

A major baking term.

Practice 9

> “The pie has a **shortcrust pastry** base.”

「這個批使用**短酥皮**作底。」

Practice 10

> “Shortcrust pastry is often used for tarts.”

「**短酥皮**常用來製作撻。」

shortcrust pastry = 以較高脂肪比例製成、口感酥鬆的糕點麵糰

6. **filo/phyllo pastry** = 菲羅酥皮；薄酥皮

A common culinary compound.

Practice 11

> “The dessert uses layers of **filo pastry**.”

「這款甜品使用多層**薄酥皮**。」

Practice 12

> “Filo pastry is very thin and delicate.”

「**菲羅酥皮**非常薄而脆弱。」

filo pastry = 極薄、通常多層使用的酥皮

7. **pastry chef** = 糕點師；甜點師

A useful occupational compound.

Practice 13

> “The bakery hired a new **pastry chef**.”

「這間麵包店聘請了一位新的**糕點師**。」

Practice 14

> “She trained as a pastry chef in Paris.”

「她在巴黎接受**糕點師**訓練。」

****pastry chef = 專門製作糕點、甜點、酥點等的專業廚師****

8. ****pastry case / pastry shell = 撻皮；酥皮外殼****

A useful baking compound.

Practice 15

> “Fill the ****pastry case**** with custard.”

「把吉士餡倒入****撻皮****中。」

Practice 16

> “The pastry shell should be crisp.”

「這個****酥皮外殼****應該酥脆。」

****pastry case/shell = 用酥皮麵糰烘製、用來承載餡料的外殼****

Important distinction: ****pastry vs bread****

You just curated ****bread****.

****bread****

usually:

* yeast-based or bread-like dough

* staple baked food

****pastry****

usually:

* flour + fat

- * richer dough
- * often flaky, crumbly, or delicate

- > bread = 麵包
- > pastry = 酥點 / 糕點

There is some culinary overlap, but everyday usage distinguishes them clearly.

Important distinction: **pastry vs cake**

pastry

usually based on pastry dough.

cake

usually based on batter or softer cake mixture.

- > tart = pastry
- > sponge cake = cake

Not all sweet baked goods are pastries.

Important distinction: **pastry vs dessert**

pastry

describes a type of baked food or dough.

dessert

describes a course eaten after a meal.

A pastry can be a dessert, but not every dessert is pastry.

For example:

- * fruit tart = pastry and dessert
- * ice cream = dessert, not pastry

Important distinction: **pastry vs pie**

pastry

can mean the dough/material or a broader category of items.

pie

is a specific dish with filling enclosed or topped by pastry.

So:

> pie uses pastry

> but

> pastry is not the same as pie.

Important distinction: **pastry vs tart**

Your passage also has **tart** later.

pastry

broad category/material.

tart

specific baked item with pastry base and filling, usually open-topped.

> pastry = 酥皮 / 糕點類

> tart = 撻

Important distinction: **pastry vs croissant**

pastry

broad category.

croissant

specific laminated yeast pastry.

In everyday bakery language, a croissant is often treated as a pastry.

Important distinction: **pastry — mass noun vs countable noun**

This is the key grammar point.

Uncountable:

> “Roll out the pastry.”

= 把**酥皮麵糰**擀開。

Countable:

> “She bought three pastries.”

= 她買了三件**酥點**。

Same spelling, different countability and meaning.

Excellent MCQ material.

Important distinction: **pastry vs pastries**

pastry

can mean:

* dough/material

* the culinary field/category

pastries

normally means:

* individual baked pastry items

So in your passage:

> “bread, pastries, cakes”

clearly means:

> 一件件糕點 / 酥點

not the raw dough.

Important distinction: **pastry chef vs baker**

baker

broadly makes bread and baked goods.

pastry chef

specializes in pastries, desserts, and fine baked sweets.

A small bakery employee may do both roles, but the titles differ.

Important note on polysemy depth

Pastry is not a huge polysemy word.

The genuinely useful modern inventory is mainly:

1. **pastry = dough**
2. **pastry = individual baked item**
3. **pastry = pastry-making field/category**

Then the rest are useful compounds:

- * puff pastry
- * shortcrust pastry
- * filo pastry
- * pastry chef
- * pastry case

So we should **not over-split every type of pastry into a new meaning**.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **pastry — dough** = 酥皮麵糰 / 糕點麵糰
 * **pastry — individual item** = 酥點 / 糕點
 * **pastry — culinary field/category** = 糕點製作 / 糕點類
 * **puff pastry** = 千層酥皮
 * **shortcrust pastry** = 短酥皮
 * **filo pastry** = 薄酥皮 / 菲羅酥皮
 * **pastry chef** = 糕點師
 * **pastry case/shell** = 撻皮 / 酥皮外殼

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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pastry — dough	以麵粉、脂肪等製成，用來做批、撻、酥點的麵糰
pastry — baked item	由酥皮 / 糕點麵糰製成的一件烘焙食品
pastry — field/category	糕點製作這個烘焙專業 / 食品類別
puff pastry	多層摺疊後烘焙成層層酥脆結構的千層酥皮
shortcrust pastry	口感酥鬆、常用作批 / 撻底的短酥皮
filo pastry	極薄、常多層使用的薄酥皮
pastry chef	專門製作糕點、酥點及甜品的專業廚師
pastry case/shell	用酥皮製成、用來承載餡料的外殼 / 撻皮

For your original sentence

> “Basically, the shop sells handmade bread, **pastries**, cakes...”

The exact meaning is:

pastries = 麵包店內一件件以酥皮 / 糕點麵糰製成的烘焙食品，而不是 raw pastry dough. ******

Natural translation:

> ******「基本上，這間店售賣手工麵包、酥點 / 糕點、蛋糕……」******

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **pastry dough** → 酥皮麵糰
- > **a pastry** → 一件酥點 / 糕點
- > **pastries** → 多件酥點
- > **puff pastry** → 千層酥皮
- > **shortcrust pastry** → 短酥皮
- > **pastry chef** → 糕點師
- > **pastry vs bread** → 酥點 / 糕點 vs 麵包
- > **pastry vs cake** → 酥皮類糕點 vs 蛋糕